

ALEX XIONG

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EDUCATION

Cornell University, New York, NY

Aug 2025 - May 2027

MS in Applied Info Science & Info Systems – Connective Media

Courseload: Branding for Products, HCI & Design, UXR, Applied Machine Learning, Producing Tech

New York University, New York, NY

Sep 2021 - May 2025

BFA in Game Design | Minor in Business Entertainment Media Technology, GPA: 3.82

RESEARCH

Cornell University - Game Assemblies Lab, *Research Assistant*, New York, NY

Oct 2025 - Present

Advisor: Jose Sanchez, Director of Plethora Project & Associate Professor at Cornell

- Building a user voice-controlled LLM-NPC in Unreal Engine 5, integrating Claude, Whisper, ElevenLabs, and an OpenCV/ONNX facial-expression model; driving dialogue and adaptive NPC behavior with no scripted lines.
- Designed an emotion-and-dialogue architecture: a Plutchik 8-emotion PAD state machine with GOAP-inspired transition and a Blackboard layer reconciling LLM outputs with gamification; grounded in CASA research on social responses to AI.
- Designed the prototype as a framework for Unreal Engine: procedurally-generated, emotion-aware NPCs configurable through natural-language prompts, with planned open-source to make agents accessible to game developers across projects.
- Field-deployed the prototype at Cornell Tech Open Studio for HCI graduates and industry visitors.
- **Prior lab work:** Python computer-vision bridge (OpenCV, MediaPipe), translating webcam gestures into 6-DOF manipulation in Autodesk Maya as a low-friction alternative to specialized VR/AR hardware in creative tools.

PANDA – Print Augmentation & Navigation Display Array, INFO 5358, 3D Interaction Design

Mar - May 2026

- AR guidance system for Cornell Tech MakerLAB Bambu 3D printers targeting Meta Orion glasses; ran contextual inquiry, authored the System Concept Statement per Hartson & Pyla UX Wheel, designed two user flows (pre-arrival prep, in-lab interaction), and built an interactive Figma prototype.

NYU Stern Center for Business and Human Rights, *Research Assistant*, New York, NY

Nov 2022 - Mar 2023

Advisor: Mariana Olaizola Rosenblat, Policy Advisor on Technology & Law

- Conducted mixed-method research to map users' real-world decision-making, uncovering behavioral patterns and UX failure points that directly informed evidence-based recommendations featured in a public policy report, "**Gaming the System.**"
- Led multinational surveys of **250+** participants, coded qualitative data to support evidence for **70+** key research articles.
- Used **ethnographic methods** to identify recurring failure modes and social-influence mechanisms, informing competitive analysis of platform-level interventions.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Silverjay Studio LLC, *Founder & Producer*, New York, NY

Sept 2021 - Present

*Independent game startup developing narrative-driven adventure experiences, including the award-winning **Song of Maka.***

- **Led 30+ human-subject studies** on a shipped game (interviews, usability tests, diary studies); coded **500+ behavioral datapoints** into findings on player motivation and friction that informed iterative design and product requirements.
- Conducted longitudinal observational research across **48 months** of development, coordinating structured study protocols with a **15-person** cross-functional team.
- Secured **\$500K** seed funding at **\$4.8M** valuation; presented design rationale at **PAX West and GDC**, with 1000+ attendees.

NYU Changemaker Center, *Communications & Design Intern*, New York, NY

June 2024 - May 2025

Advised students on global awards and experimental learning through research, event planning, and design.

- Designed mixed-methods studies (surveys, usability tests, semi-structured interviews) modeling student decision-making; findings shaped onboarding flows serving **2,000+ students/year**.
- Built engagement dashboards in Python; defined evaluation metrics adopted by directors to assess events across departments.
- Designed and evaluated cross-departmental student programming with university directors, drawing **300+ attendees per event**, measured against engagement and satisfaction protocols.

Tencent Games, *Games Service & Product Management Intern*, Shenzhen, China

July 2023 - Sept 2023

Games Service Department: player behavior research, gameplay, and LiveOps insights.

- Analyzed **90K+ player interaction logs** across **15 titles** in SQL/Python; quantified behavioral patterns and friction points along retention and monetization funnels to inform empirically-grounded design interventions (**~7% ARPDAU lift**).
- Partnered with data science and engineering to translate exploratory findings into testable hypotheses for **10+ LiveOps campaigns**; authored a feature specification and competitive analyses of 10 products that became a persistent team reference.

SKILLS/CERTIFICATIONS

Technical: Python, SQL, JavaScript/HTML, C++/C#, Git, Excel, Unreal Engine 5, Jira/Confluence/Notion, Figma, Adobe Suite

AI/ML: Claude API, Whisper, ElevenLabs, ONNX Runtime, OpenCV, MediaPipe, PyTorch, Prompt Engineering, RAG

Functional: Product Management, PRDs, Competitive Analysis, A/B Testing, KPIs, User Research, Cross-Functional Collaboration

Awards: Adobe Designathon Best Overall 2026, CUSGA Best Game 2024, GWB Gameplay Innovation 2024, IndiePlay Best Student

Certificates: Certified ScrumMaster, UCSD Probability for Deep Learning, UCLA DS, and Algorithms for Software Dev